Lesson plan · for the teacher

Check before you trust

AI · Level 1 · Lesson 4

Time
40 min

Materials
Board and chalk (or paper on the wall); Five statements on a slip: four true, one made up; Your pupils' textbook (and an atlas, if you have one); Worksheet: Fact detectives (one per pair, optional)

Learning goals

- Explain that a chatbot can sound sure and still be wrong.
- Name ways to check a fact: a textbook, a teacher, a library or an elder.
- Use Ask → Check → Decide, and keep personal details private.

Activity: Spot the made-up fact: Spot it

1. Warm-up (5 min): Ask: "A friend tells you something surprising. How do you find out if it's true?" List pupils' ideas on the board.
2. Teach (8 min): Explain that chatbots are computer programs — not robots — that write by guessing likely words. Draw a speech bubble with a question mark.
3. Spot it (12 min): Read the five statements in a confident 'robot' voice. Pupils vote for the made-up one with one to five fingers. Ask two pupils how they would check, then show the textbook page.
4. Pair talk (8 min): Write the three extra statements on the board. Pairs decide: true or made up? Where could they check, and who could they ask? Check one together.
5. Wrap-up (7 min): Write Ask → Check → Decide on the board. Add: never type your name, address, phone number or photo into a chatbot. Exit ticket: one fact and where to check it.

Pick four true facts from your pupils' textbook and note each page. Write one false statement that sounds just as sure, such as "Bats are birds." Prepare three more statements for pair talk.

Discussion

- Does saying something confidently make it true?
- Which statement did I make up — and how could you check?
- Where could we check this, and who could we ask?

Exit ticket

- One fact I learned today, and where I would check it.

Try it in class tomorrow
Play "Spot the made-up fact": Read five statements in a confident 'robot' voice — four from the textbook, one made up. Pupils vote for the fake, then say how they would check: textbook, teacher, library or an elder. Show the textbook page. Finish by writing Ask → Check → Decide on the board.

Worksheet · for pupils

Check before you trust

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **Why can a chatbot give an answer that sounds sure but is wrong?**

- ◯ It is lying on purpose to trick you
- ◯ It predicts likely words instead of checking facts
- ◯ Its internet connection was too slow
- ◯ It only gets hard subjects wrong

2 **If a chatbot sounds sure, it is probably right.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

3 **Match each claim to a good place to check it.**

The date of a national exam	• • • •	A library catalogue or librarian
Which countries share Lake Victoria	• • • •	Your science textbook
How plants make their food	• • • •	An atlas
A book the chatbot recommends	• • • •	The official exam timetable

4 **Ask, check, decide — step by step. Put the steps in order.**

- ☐ Decide what to keep, fix or drop
- ☐ Check key facts in a trusted source
- ☐ Mark the facts that matter most
- ☐ Read the whole answer carefully
- ☐ Ask clearly, without pupils' details

5 **Which parts of an AI answer should you check before you use them?**

- ☐ Facts, numbers and dates
- ☐ Its friendly greeting
- ☐ Books, quotes or sources it names
- ☐ How fluent its sentences sound
- ☐ Health or safety advice

✎ **Think of one thing you might ask an AI tool for your class. What would you check before using the answer — and where?**